Project Desk

User Manual

Version 2.4.0
November 2026

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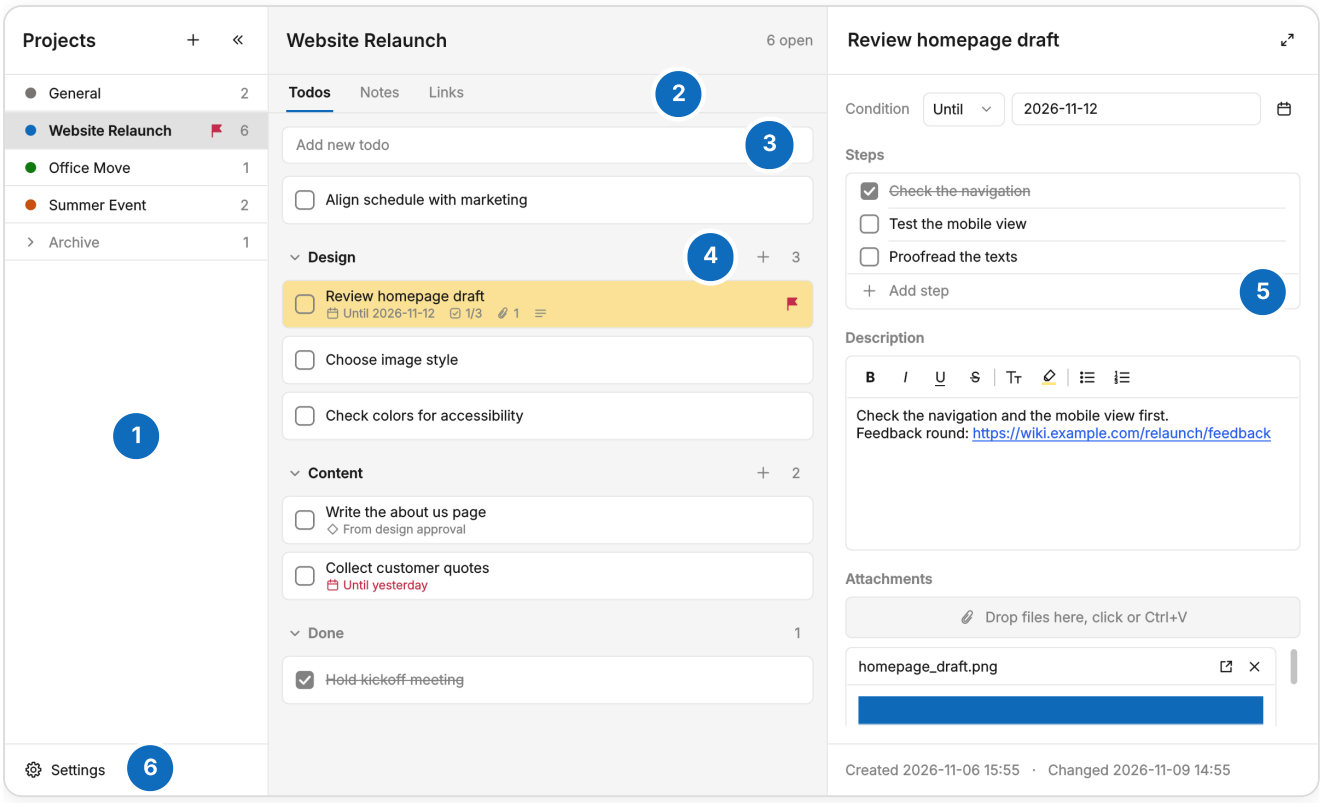
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The Main Window

Project Desk keeps everything that belongs to a project in one place: todos, notes and links. The window has three columns: your projects on the left, the entries of the open project in the middle and the details of the selected entry on the right.



The main window with the todos of a project

1. **Projects**: the fixed project **General**, your projects and the archive. The number shows the open todos, a red flag shows flagged todos.
2. **Tabs**: todos, notes and links of the project. Tabs you do not need can be hidden in the settings.
3. **Input field**: type and press `Enter` to add an entry.
4. **Group**: entries can be sorted into groups. The **+** adds an entry to the group.
5. **Details** of the selected entry. The icon at the top right enlarges this column to the full window.
6. **Settings**: mode, language, zoom, tabs, storage location and backups.

> **Good to know.** Most actions are in the right-click menu, and a double-click renames. Changes are saved automatically, and `Ctrl` + `Z` undoes any change.

Installation and First Start

Installation

1. Download **ProjectDesk_Setup.exe** from the latest release of the Project Desk repository on GitHub.
2. If Windows blocks the file, right-click it, choose **Properties**, select **Unblock** on the **General** tab and click **OK**.
3. Run the setup. No administrator rights are required. If SmartScreen shows a warning, click **More info** and then **Run anyway**.

First start

Project Desk asks for a folder to store all data. A folder in OneDrive is a good choice, since OneDrive backs it up. The folder can be changed later (see **Storage Location**).

Updates

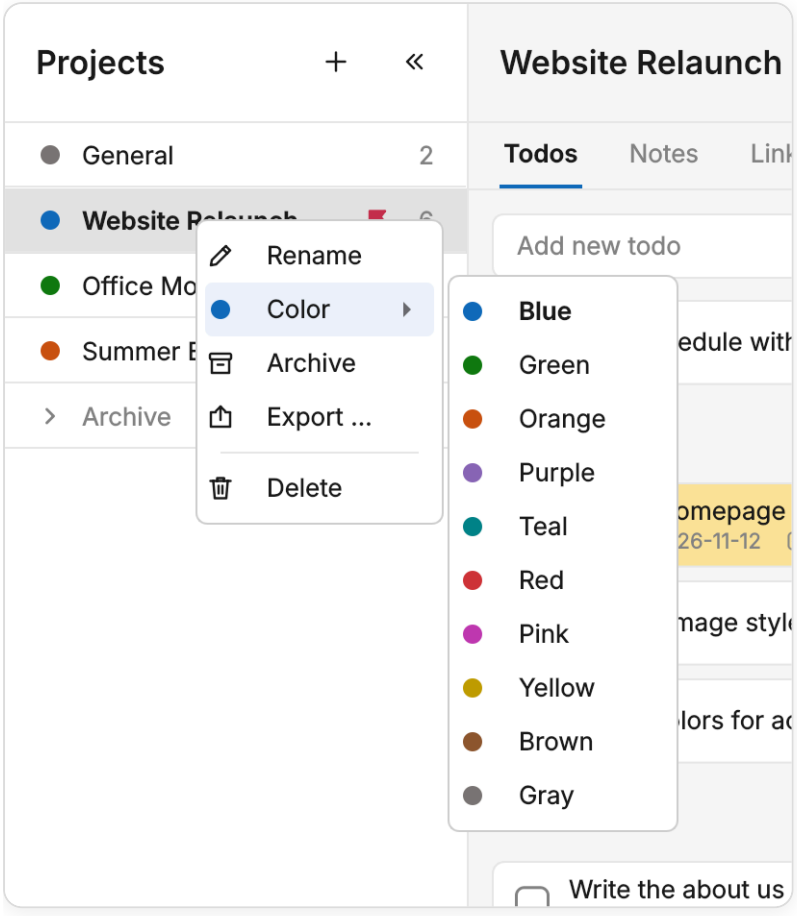
When a new version is available, the settings icon shows a blue dot (see **Settings**). Install the new version over the current one. Data and settings are kept. An existing installation of the predecessor **ToDo** is updated the same way.

Only one Project Desk window runs at a time. Starting the program again brings the open window to the front.

Projects

The project **General** is always at the top and holds everything that does not belong to a specific project.

- **New project**: click **+** next to **Projects** or right-click the empty space below the projects. Type the name and press `Enter`.
- **Rename**: double-click the project or right-click it and choose **Rename**.
- **Color**: right-click the project and choose a color.
- **Order**: drag a project up or down.
- **Archive**: right-click the project and choose **Archive**, or drag it onto **Archive**. A click on **Archive** shows the archived projects. **Restore** in the right-click menu brings a project back.
- **Delete**: right-click the project and choose **Delete**, or press `Delete`. Project Desk asks for confirmation.
- **More space**: **«** collapses the project column to a narrow strip, **»** expands it again.



Right-click menu of a project with the colors

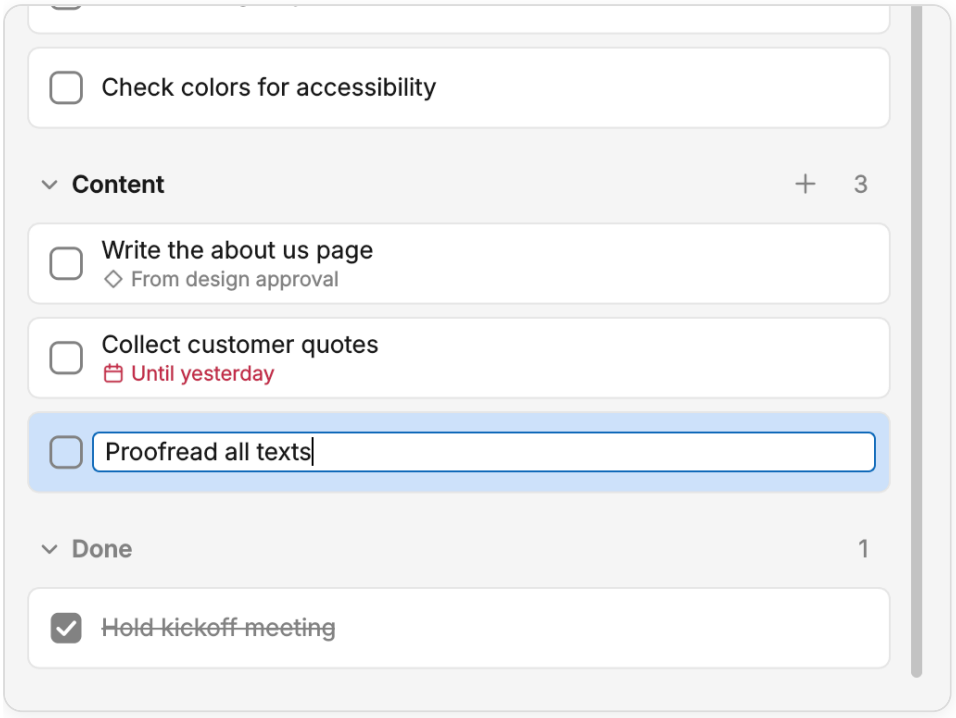
Tabs and Groups

Every project has the tabs **Todos**, **Notes** and **Links**. Each tab has its own groups, for example **Design** and **Content**. Groups are optional, entries without a group appear at the top. Each project remembers the tab that was open last.

- **New group**: right-click the empty space in the list and choose **New group**.
- **Collapse or expand**: click the group header.
- **Rename**: double-click the group header.
- **Order**: drag the group header up or down.
- **Delete**: right-click the group header and choose **Delete**. The entries remain without a group.

Adding entries to a group

Click **+** on the group header and type the name. `Enter` saves the entry and starts the next one, `Esc` stops. In the notes tab, `Enter` continues in the text of the new note.



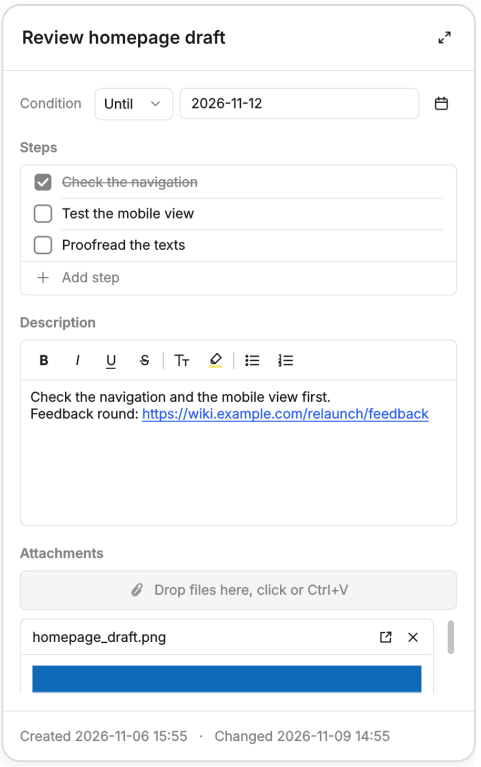
A new todo typed directly into the group Content

Moving entries

Drag an entry to another position, into another group or onto a collapsed group header. Dropping it onto a project on the left moves it to that project.

Todos

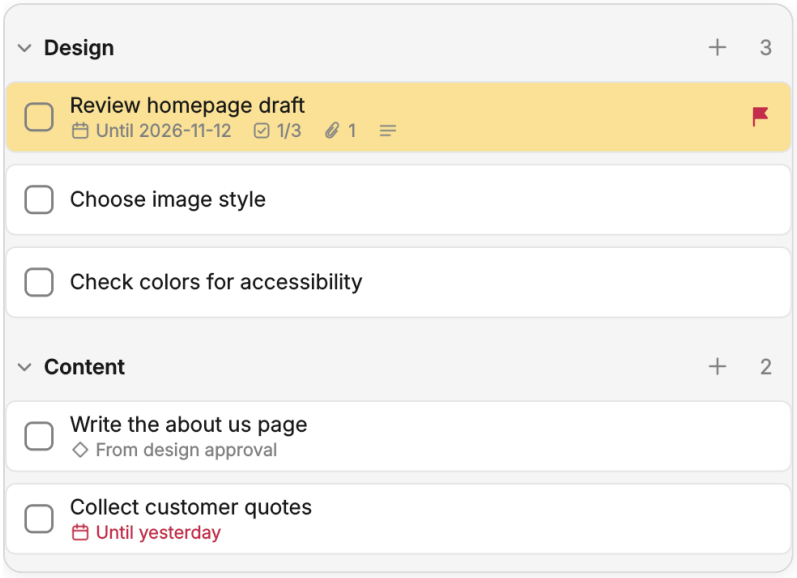
- **Add**: type into **Add new todo** and press Enter.
- **Done**: click the checkbox. The todo moves to **Done** at the end of the list and loses its flag. Clicking the checkbox again reopens it.
- **Flag**: right-click an open todo and choose **Flag**. Flagged todos have a yellow background and a red flag at the right edge, and the project shows a red flag. **Remove flag** in the right-click menu removes it.
- **Rename**: double-click the todo in the list or edit the title on the right.



Details of a todo with condition, steps, description and attachment

In the list

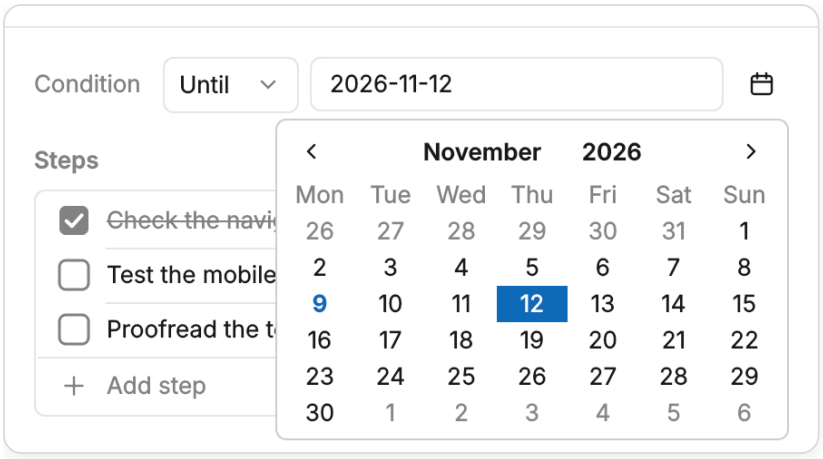
Long titles are shortened in the list. Point at a todo to see the full title. Below the title, a todo shows what it contains: the condition, the progress of its steps, the number of attachments and an icon when it has a description.



Todos with condition, steps, attachment and description

Condition

A todo can have a condition: **Until** for a deadline or **From** for the earliest start. Choose the kind next to **Condition** and enter a date such as 14.11. or 2026-11-14, or a text such as "design approval". The calendar icon selects a date, **None** removes the condition.

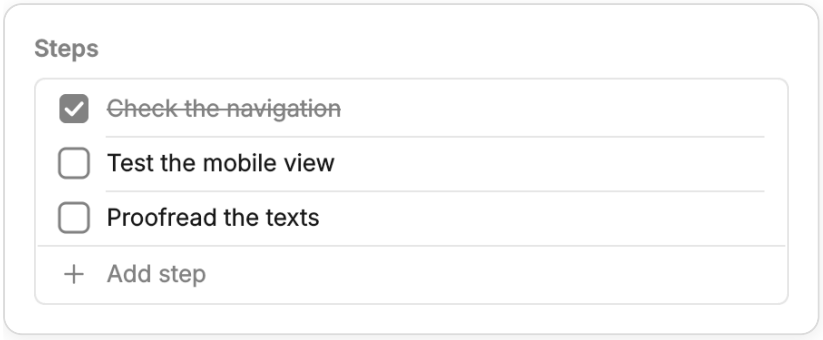


Selecting a deadline in the calendar

In the list a calendar icon stands before a date and a diamond before a text. A deadline that is today or past is red, a start date that has been reached is blue.

Steps

Steps break a todo into smaller tasks. Type a step into **Add step** and press `Enter`, the field stays ready for the next one. Click the checkbox of a step when it is done. The todo itself is checked separately.



Steps of a todo

- **Rename**: double-click the step.
- **Order**: drag the step up or down.
- **Delete**: right-click the step and choose **Delete**. `Ctrl`+`Z` brings it back.

Description

Descriptions, notes and link notes share this toolbar:



Toolbar for formatting text

- **Bold** (`Ctrl`+`B`), *italic* (`Ctrl`+`I`), underline (`Ctrl`+`U`) and ~~strikethrough~~.
- **Font size**: Small, Normal, Large or Extra large, for example for headings. The sizes follow the zoom.
- **Highlight**: marks the selected text in yellow.
- **Bullet list** and **Numbered list**: `Tab` indents a list line, `Shift`+`Tab` outdents it. A dash followed by a space at the start of a line also starts a bullet list.

Web addresses and network paths become links automatically and open with a click.

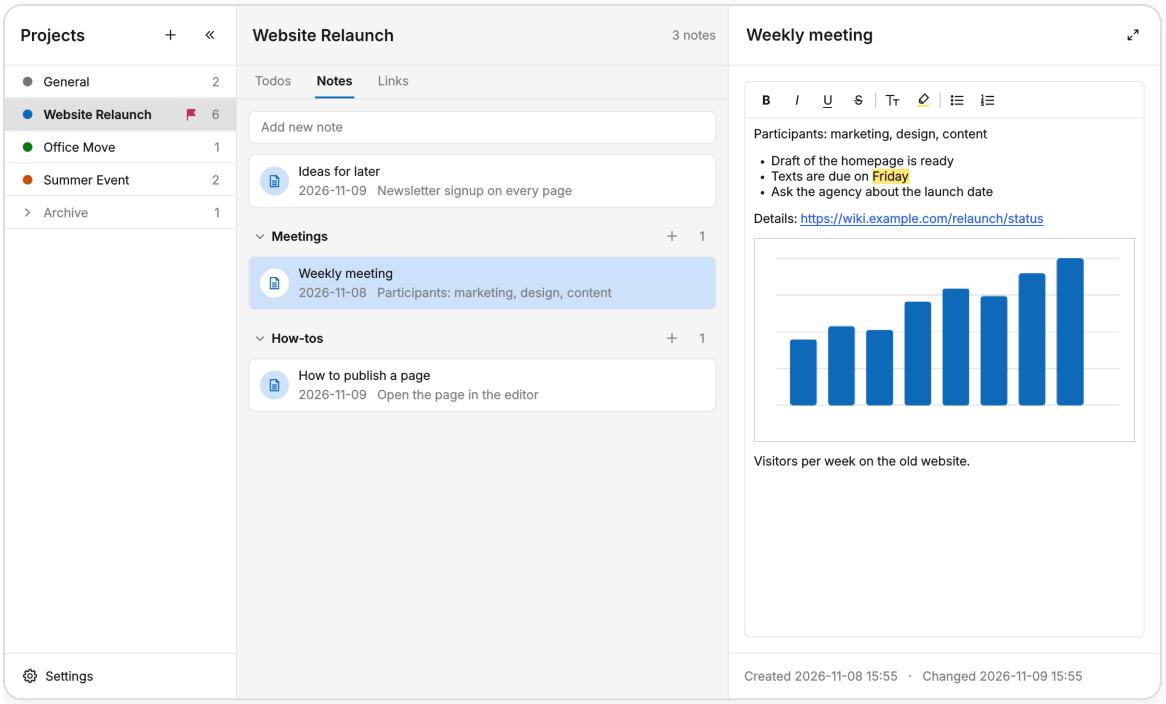
Attachments

Drop files onto **Drop files here, click or Ctrl+V**, click it to choose files, or paste files and screenshots with `Ctrl` + `V`. Images and PDF files show a preview. The icons next to the file name open the file or remove it.

> **Note.** Attachments are copied to the storage folder, so the original file can be moved or deleted.

Notes

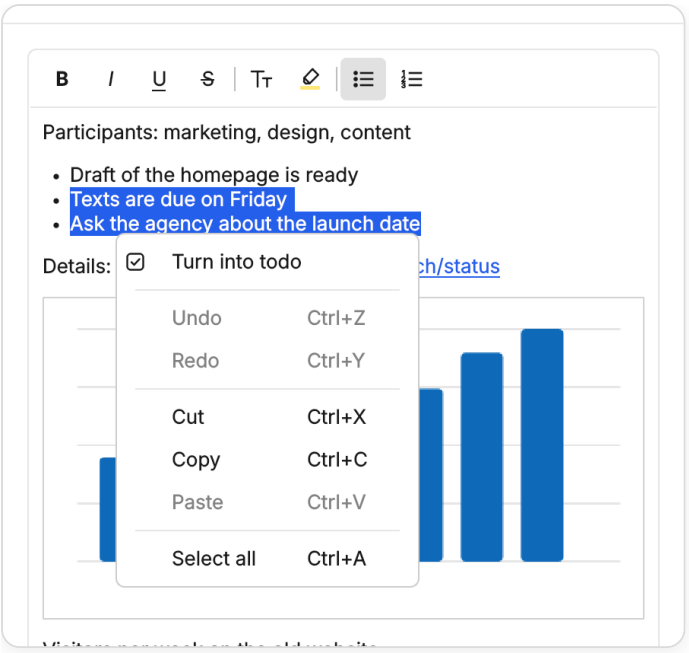
- **Add**: type a title into **Add new note** and press Enter. Enter in the empty field creates a note named after today's date.
- **Text**: the same formatting as in todo descriptions.
- **Images**: paste screenshots with Ctrl + V. Each image gets its own line and fits the width of the note. A double-click shows it full size.
- **PDF**: right-click the note in the list and choose **Export as PDF**.



A note with bullet list, link and image

Turning lines into todos

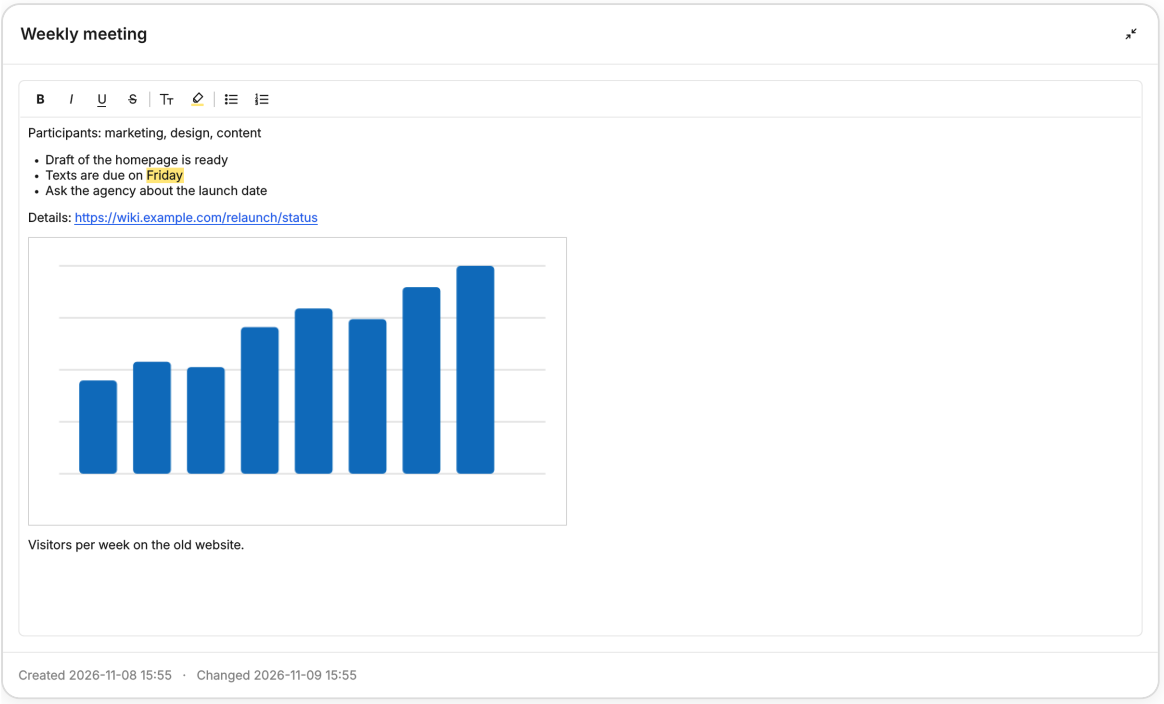
Select one or more lines, or place the cursor in a line, then right-click and choose **Turn into todo**. The lines become todos of the same project and are marked with a check mark in the note, so they are not converted twice.



Turn into todo in the right-click menu of a note

More space for writing

The icon at the top right of the right column enlarges it to the full window, for example for long notes. The same icon restores the normal view.

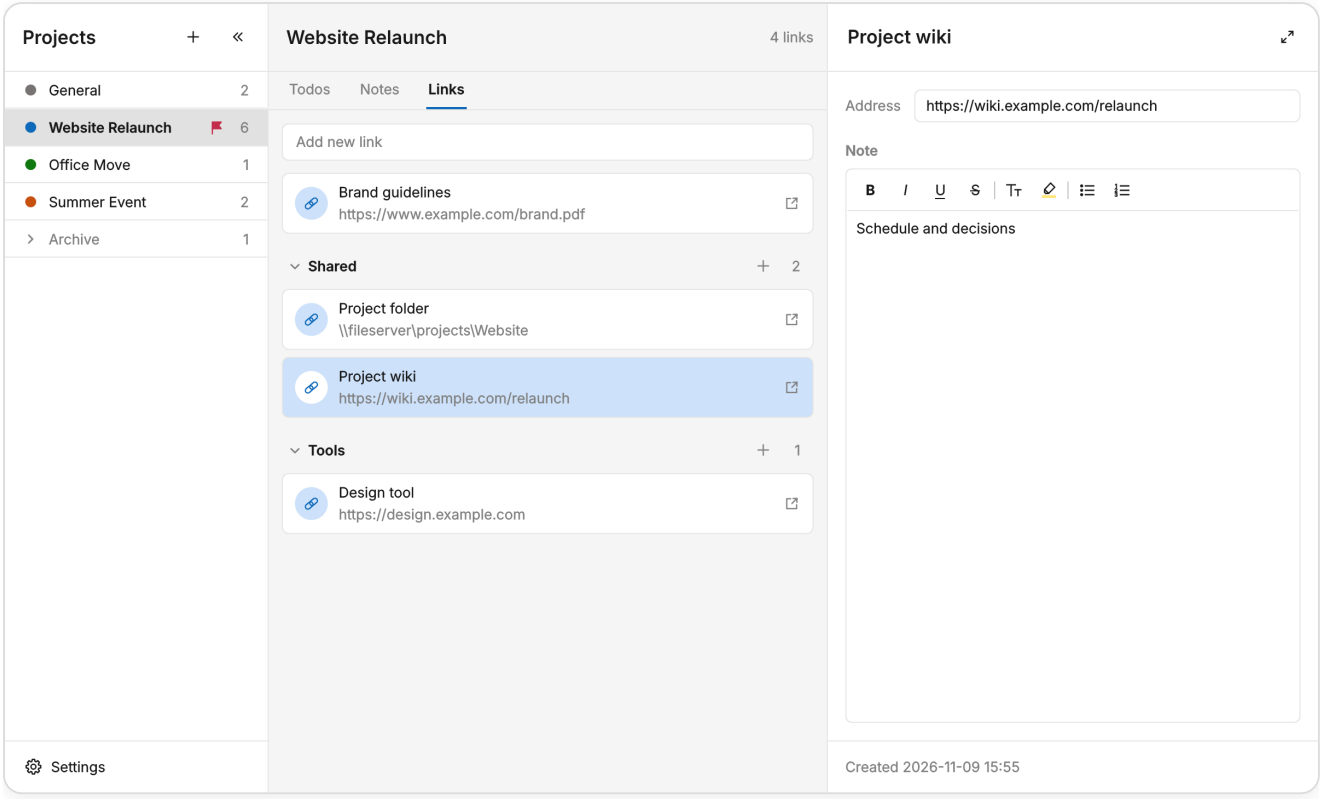


A note in the full window

Links

Links collect the places that belong to a project: web pages, shared files, network folders and tools.

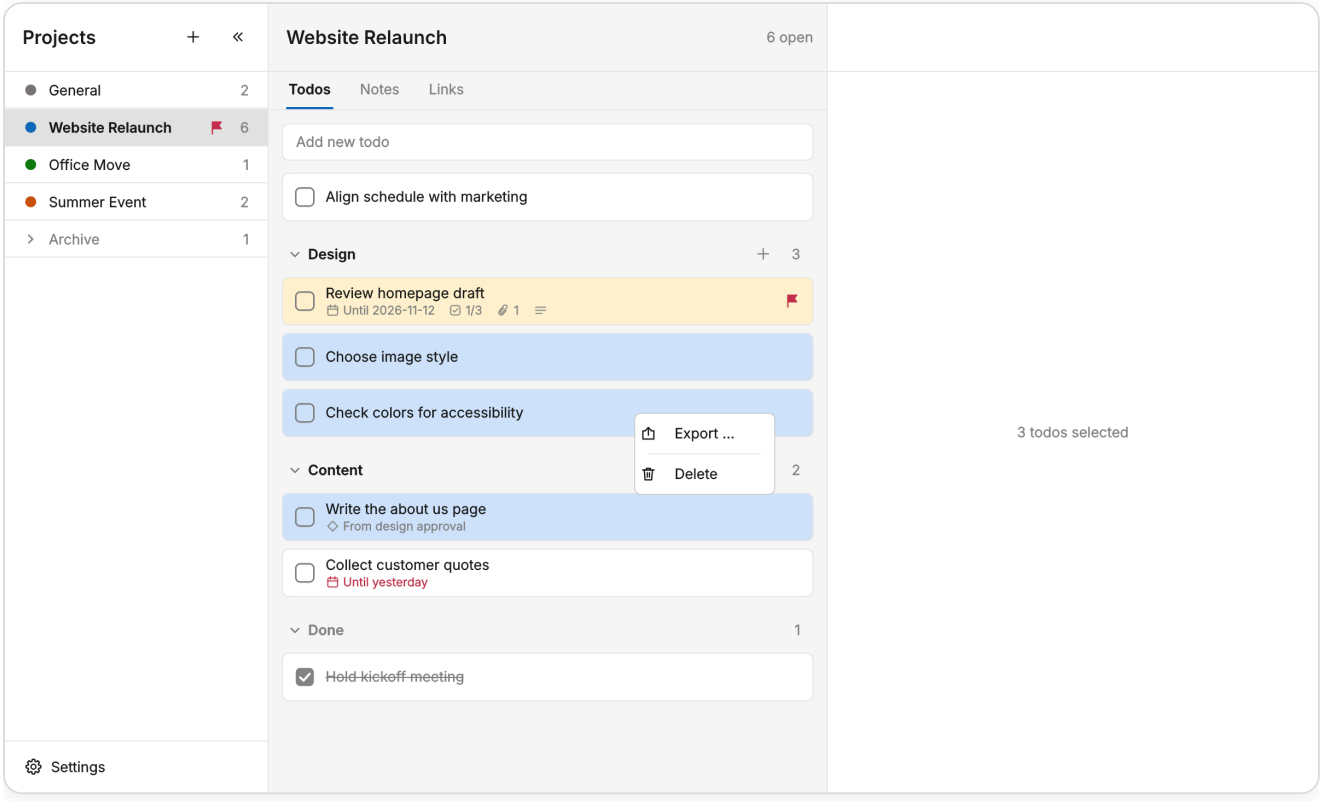
- **Add**: paste an address into **Add new link** and press Enter. The name is taken from the address and can be changed. If you type a name instead, enter the address on the right.
- Supported are web addresses, **www.** addresses, network paths such as **\\server\share** and local paths such as **C:\Tools**.
- **Open**: click the icon on the right of the link, or right-click and choose **Open**. Web pages open in the browser, folders in Explorer and files in their default program. **Copy address** copies the address to the clipboard.
- **Note**: additional information about the link.



Links in groups with address and note

Selecting Several Entries

- `Ctrl` +click adds an entry to the selection or removes it.
- `Shift` +click selects all entries between the selected and the clicked entry.
- `Ctrl` + `A` selects all entries of the tab, `Esc` clears the selection.
- **Move**: drag one of the selected entries. All selected entries move with it, into a group or onto a project.
- **Export or delete**: right-click one of the selected entries. `Delete` deletes the selection after confirmation.



Three selected todos with their right-click menu

Undo and Redo

`Ctrl` + `Z` undoes the last change, `Ctrl` + `Y` or `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z` redoes it. This applies to every change, including deleting, moving, renaming, checking off, imports and restored backups. Deleted attachments and images are restored as well.

While a text field has focus, `Ctrl` + `Z` first undoes the typing in that field. Up to 50 changes can be undone. Closing Project Desk clears the undo history, the backups remain.

Sharing with Colleagues

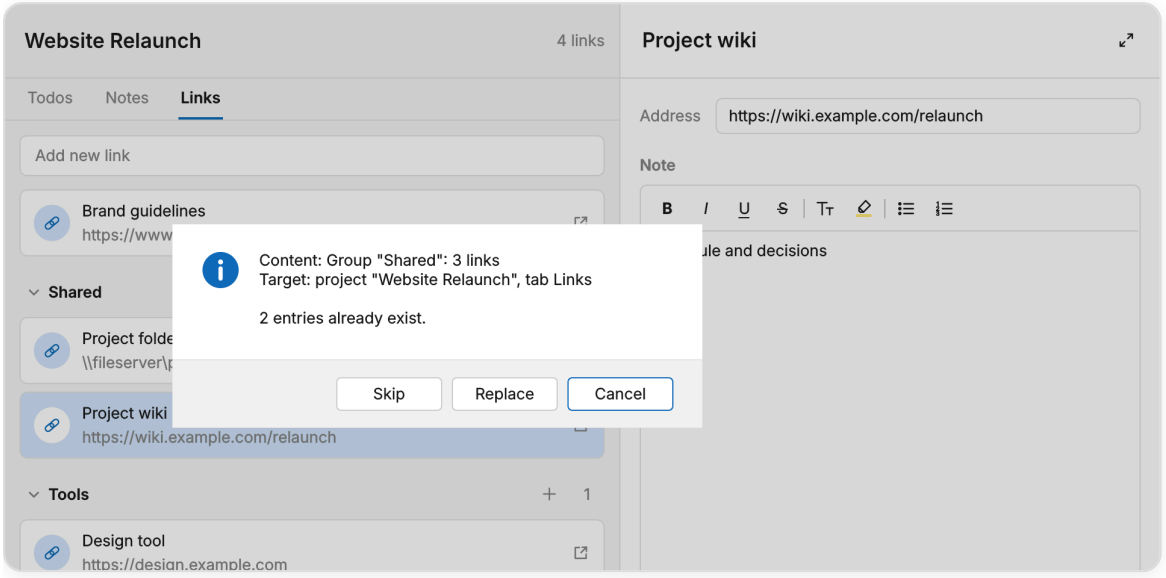
Export

Right-click an entry, a group, a project or several selected entries and choose **Export ...**. Project Desk creates a **.pdesk** file with all content, including attachments and images. Send it by email, Teams or a shared drive.

Import

- Double-click the **.pdesk** file in Explorer,
- drop it onto the Project Desk window, or
- right-click the empty space in a list or in the project column and choose **Import ...**.

Before anything changes, Project Desk shows the content of the file and its destination. Entries and groups go into the open project, always into the matching tab. A project is added as a new project. A hidden tab becomes visible again when entries are imported into it.

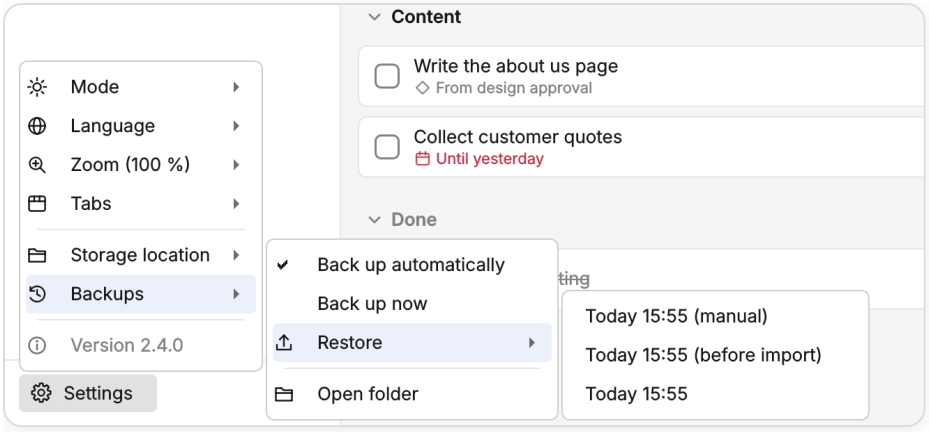


The import asks how to handle existing entries

If entries already exist, **Skip** keeps your version and **Replace** takes the imported one. An entry counts as existing if it is the same entry or a link with the same address. Every import creates a backup first and can be undone with <kbd>Ctrl</kbd> + <kbd>Z</kbd>.

Backups

Project Desk backs up your data automatically once a day, and also before every import, before moving the data and before restoring a backup. The 30 most recent backups are kept.



Settings, Backups, Restore

- **Back up automatically**: turns the daily backup on or off. It is on by default.
- **Back up now**: creates a backup immediately.
- **Restore**: lists all backups with date and reason. Restoring asks for confirmation and backs up the current state first. Ctrl + Z undoes the restore.
- **Open folder**: shows the backup files in Explorer.

Confirmations such as **Backup created** appear briefly in a blue bar at the bottom of the window.



Confirmation at the bottom of the window

Storage Location

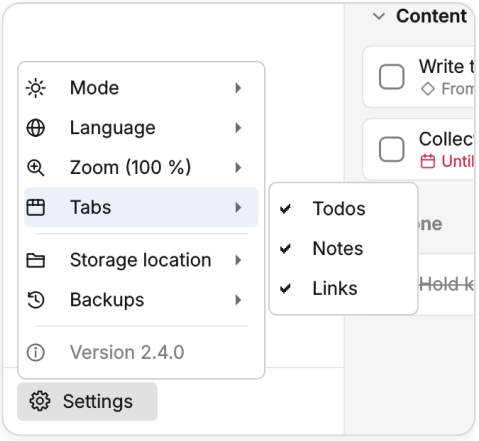
Settings, **Storage location** shows the folder that holds your data.

- **Open in Explorer**: opens the folder.
- **Move data ...**: moves all data, attachments, images and backups to a new, empty folder. The copy is verified before the old files are removed.
- **Open other storage location ...**: switches to a folder that already contains Project Desk data, for example on a new computer.

> **Important.** Use a storage folder with only one Project Desk at a time. To share content with colleagues, use export and import.

Settings

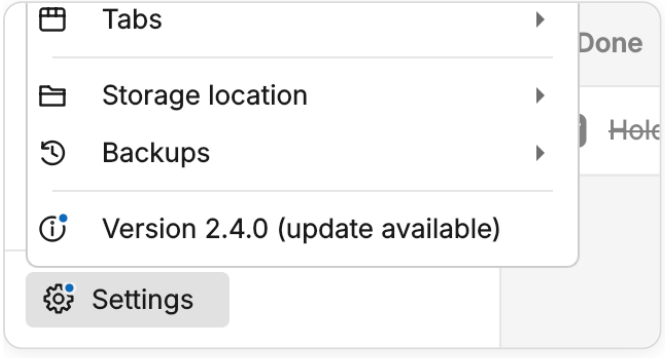
- **Mode**: **Same as Windows**, **Light** or **Dark**.
- **Language**: Deutsch or English.
- **Zoom**: enlarges or reduces everything, also with `Ctrl` + `+`, `Ctrl` + `-`, `Ctrl` + `0` or `Ctrl` and the mouse wheel.
- **Tabs**: shows or hides **Todos**, **Notes** and **Links**. Hidden tabs keep their entries. At least one tab remains, and with a single tab the tab row is hidden.
- **Storage location** and **Backups**: see the previous chapters.
- The bottom line shows the installed version.



Settings, Tabs

New versions

At every start Project Desk checks GitHub for a newer version.
If there is one, a blue bar shows **Update available** once and the settings icon gets a blue dot. The version line then shows **(update available)**, and a click on it opens the download page. The dot remains until the new version is installed. Without an internet connection nothing is shown.



A new version in the settings

Keyboard Shortcuts

ACTION	KEYS
Add an entry from the input field	Enter
Rename the selected entry	Double-click or F2
Cancel renaming	Esc
Delete the selected entries or project	Delete
Undo	Ctrl + Z
Redo	Ctrl + Y or Ctrl + Shift + Z
Add an entry to the selection	Ctrl +click
Select a range	Shift +click
Select all entries of the tab	Ctrl + A
Clear the selection	Esc
Paste attachments, screenshots and images	Ctrl + V
Bold, italic, underline	Ctrl + B, Ctrl + I, Ctrl + U
Indent or outdent a list line	Tab, Shift + Tab
Zoom in, zoom out, reset	Ctrl + +, Ctrl + -, Ctrl + 0